backwards and boorish. […] Furthermore, the idea that heterosexuality is a social construct completely neglects the reality that humans are sexually reproducing species. The idea that homosexuality is a social construct neglects the plentiful evidence that it is also a biological reality.'[221]

But the authors emphasise that 'liberalism does not require one to believe that gender and sexuality are socially constructed in order to argue that there is no justification for discriminating against anyone'.[222] They point out that 'postmodern theory and liberalism do not merely exist in tension: they are almost directly at odds with one another. Liberalism sees knowledge as something we can learn about reality, more or less objectively'.[223] On the other side, 'illiberalism is easily recognisable in totalitarian, hierarchical, censorious, feudal, patriarchal, colonial, or theocratic states'.[224] However, 'it is opposed not to conservatism in general, but to the kind of conservatism that seeks to conserve hierarchies of class, race, or gender.'[225] This is contrary to critical race and related theories that use a 'simplistic identity politics approach which ascribes collective blame to dominant groups'.[226] Pluckrose and Lindsay (the latter was permanently suspended from Twitter in August 2022 for violating rules against hate speech), who at this point somehow naturally comes to mention Mr Orbán (as the person who promoted a ban on gender studies), insist that we cannot fight illiberalism with illiberalism, and at the same time warn that 'through the systematic and near-total silencing of reasonable and moderate voices from the left, center, and center-right, Social Justice opens itself and our society up most precariously and certainly to an authoritarian far-right backlash.'[227]

Is this what has been in fact happening in Poland and Hungary, but also elsewhere? It seems David Goodhart would at least partially agree. In addition to the 'trinity of populist concerns – immigration, security and corruption'[228] [of liberal elites], he devotes an entire chapter of his book *The Road to Somewhere* to the issues of family and gender. He argues that we have lost sight of 'how to create new forms of mutually beneficial inter-dependence between men and women in an era of equality between the sexes, and how to preserve the two-parent family, so far as possible, in an era of greater freedom'.[229] So it is not only about the abandoning of Christian family values, but also within the liberal camp there is concern about the departure from Humanistic philosophy.

Elsewhere, Rob Riemen, the well-known Dutch liberal thinker, offers an